AI time and cost per subject

CBSE sample question papers and marking schemes, Class 10 and 12 · tested 10 November 2026

What	Result
Subjects tested	26 (9 Class 10, 17 Class 12)
Files uploaded	54: 26 question papers, 26 marking schemes, 2 answer sheets
Pages read	497 pages of papers and schemes, 29 answer-sheet pages
Question paper + marking scheme cost (all subjects)	$1.4021 · $0.00282 per page
Answer sheets cost (read + graded)	$0.0989
Total billed	**$1.5009**
Ready to grade without a teacher	26 of 26 subjects (paper and key verified by autopilot)
Models	deepseek/deepseek-v4.1-flash-1017, google/gemini-3.5-flash
Cross-check: OpenRouter key usage	$21.7500 before, $23.5168 after = $1.7667 billed (all runs in this test, including any retried)

Costs are the amounts OpenRouter billed for each call (returned with every reply and summed per file), not estimates. Times run from the start of a file's first AI call to the end of its last (queue waiting not counted); a subject's question paper and marking scheme are read at the same time.

Per subject: question paper and marking scheme (answer sheets excluded)

Cls	Subject	Files (pages)	Qns	Time to complete	Time / page	Cost: question paper	Cost: marking scheme	Cost / page	Cost per subject	Status
10	Computer Applications	QP 5, MS 5	26	77 s	7 s	$0.0056	$0.0067	$0.00122	**$0.0122**	Ready
10	English Communicative	QP 9, MS 5	12	2.6 min	10 s	$0.0140	$0.0083	$0.00159	**$0.0223**	Ready
10	English Language and Literature	QP 11, MS 9	11	3.1 min	9 s	$0.0145	$0.0128	$0.00136	**$0.0273**	Ready
10	Hindi Course A	QP 12, MS 10	15	3.2 min	8 s	$0.2166	$0.1900	$0.01848	**$0.4066**	Ready
10	Hindi Course B	QP 11, MS 8	16	3.0 min	9 s	$0.2061	$0.1582	$0.01917	**$0.3642**	Ready
10	Mathematics Basic	QP 8, MS 11	38	3.0 min	9 s	$0.0112	$0.0183	$0.00156	**$0.0296**	Ready
10	Mathematics Standard	QP 6, MS 12	38	2.3 min	7 s	$0.0077	$0.0172	$0.00139	**$0.0250**	Ready
10	Science	QP 15, MS 12	39	4.1 min	9 s	$0.0226	$0.0137	$0.00134	**$0.0363**	Ready
10	Social Science	QP 12, MS 8	38	2.8 min	8 s	$0.0154	$0.0106	$0.00130	**$0.0260**	Ready
12	Accountancy	QP 13, MS 13	34	3.6 min	8 s	$0.0164	$0.0201	$0.00140	**$0.0365**	Ready
12	Applied Mathematics	QP 9, MS 13	38	4.0 min	10 s	$0.0097	$0.0195	$0.00133	**$0.0292**	Ready
12	Biology	QP 12, MS 8	33	2.9 min	8 s	$0.0137	$0.0125	$0.00131	**$0.0262**	Ready
12	Biotechnology	QP 9, MS 8	33	2.5 min	8 s	$0.0097	$0.0099	$0.00115	**$0.0196**	Ready
12	Chemistry	QP 12, MS 12	33	3.8 min	9 s	$0.0138	$0.0145	$0.00118	**$0.0282**	Ready
12	Computer Science	QP 8, MS 10	37	2.5 min	8 s	$0.0130	$0.0124	$0.00141	**$0.0253**	Ready

Cls	Subject	Files (pages)	Qns	Time to complete	Time / page	Cost: question paper	Cost: marking scheme	Cost / page	Cost per subject	Status
12	English Core	QP 12, MS 9	13	3.8 min	10 s	$0.0178	$0.0133	$0.00148	**$0.0311**	Ready
12	English Elective	QP 12, MS 7	13	2.5 min	7 s	$0.0127	$0.0102	$0.00120	**$0.0229**	Ready
12	Entrepreneurship	QP 10, MS 6	34	2.1 min	7 s	$0.0143	$0.0132	$0.00172	**$0.0275**	Ready
12	Geography	QP 12, MS 11	30	3.0 min	7 s	$0.0140	$0.0172	$0.00136	**$0.0312**	Ready
12	History	QP 10, MS 10	34	3.2 min	9 s	$0.0113	$0.0140	$0.00126	**$0.0252**	Ready
12	Home Science	QP 4, MS 8	32	1.5 min	7 s	$0.0066	$0.0148	$0.00179	**$0.0214**	Ready
12	Informatics Practices	QP 8, MS 5	37	2.4 min	10 s	$0.0126	$0.0077	$0.00156	**$0.0203**	Ready
12	Mathematics	QP 8, MS 13	38	3.3 min	9 s	$0.0106	$0.0236	$0.00163	**$0.0342**	Ready
12	Physics	QP 10, MS 15	33	3.2 min	7 s	$0.0102	$0.0202	$0.00121	**$0.0304**	Ready
12	Political Science	QP 9, MS 10	30	2.7 min	8 s	$0.0110	$0.0141	$0.00132	**$0.0251**	Ready
12	Sociology	QP 8, MS 4	35	86 s	6 s	$0.0085	$0.0098	$0.00152	**$0.0183**	Ready
	Total (26)	**497 pages**		**73.8 min**				**$0.00282**	**$1.4021**	

Cost: marking scheme includes the autopilot's review that verifies the key against the paper. Time / page = time to read the file divided by its pages, averaged over both files.

Answer sheets: Science (Class 10) and Accountancy (Class 12)

Subject	File	Pgs	Answers	Time to read	Total (read + grade)	Time / page	Cost: reading	Cost: grading	Cost / page	Cost per sheet	Result
Science (Class 10)	sci-c-10.pdf (roll 10C06)	17	38	4.8 min	7.7 min	27 s	$0.0352	$0.0240	$0.00348	**$0.0592**	41 / 80.0 (51%), FINALIZED
Accountancy (Class 12)	acc3.pdf (roll 12B05)	12	22	3.2 min	4.9 min	25 s	$0.0269	$0.0128	$0.00331	**$0.0397**	18 / 80.0 (22%), FINALIZED

Reading covers each page read twice (the second reading checks the first), joining answers across pages, mapping them to questions and the roll-number check. Grading is one call per answered question. A school pays this per student.

Per file detail

Subject	File	Pages	AI calls	Input tokens	Output tokens	Thinking tokens	Time to read	Cost	Cost / page
Computer Applications (10)	ComputerApplication-SQP.pdf	5	5	16,199	7,198	0	36 s	$0.0056	$0.00111
Computer Applications (10)	ComputerApplication-MS.pdf	5	5	16,082	7,654	0	32 s	$0.0067	$0.00133
English Communicative (10)	EnglishComm-SQP.pdf	9	14	43,617	18,107	0	2.0 min	$0.0140	$0.00156
English Communicative (10)	EnglishComm-MS.pdf	5	5	16,018	7,943	0	28 s	$0.0083	$0.00165
English Language and Literature (10)	EnglishL-SQP.pdf	11	11	35,545	13,341	0	81 s	$0.0145	$0.00131
English Language and Literature (10)	EnglishL-MS.pdf	9	10	31,578	14,272	0	1.6 min	$0.0128	$0.00142
Hindi Course A (10)	HindiCourseA-SQP.pdf	12	12	43,656	16,789	0	1.6 min	$0.2166	$0.01805
Hindi Course A (10)	HindiCourseA-MS.pdf	10	10	34,719	15,328	0	1.5 min	$0.1900	$0.01900
Hindi Course B (10)	HindiCourseB-SQP.pdf	11	11	40,483	16,149	0	1.6 min	$0.2061	$0.01873
Hindi Course B (10)	HindiCourseB-MS.pdf	8	8	26,906	13,091	0	75 s	$0.1582	$0.01977
Mathematics Basic (10)	MathsBasic-SQP.pdf	8	8	26,082	12,685	0	67 s	$0.0112	$0.00140
Mathematics Basic (10)	MathsBasic-MS.pdf	11	11	36,068	20,998	0	1.6 min	$0.0183	$0.00167
Mathematics Standard (10)	MathsStandard-SQP.pdf	6	6	21,249	11,352	0	48 s	$0.0077	$0.00129
Mathematics Standard (10)	MathsStandard-MS.pdf	12	12	38,761	20,841	0	74 s	$0.0172	$0.00143
Science (10)	Science-SQP.pdf	15	16	50,215	21,709	0	1.9 min	$0.0226	$0.00150
Science (10)	Science-MS.pdf	12	12	37,961	18,234	0	2.1 min	$0.0137	$0.00114
Science (10)	sci-c-10.pdf	17	108	319,203	45,572	17,510	4.8 min	$0.0592	$0.00348
Social Science (10)	SocialScience-SQP.pdf	12	12	37,944	13,954	0	83 s	$0.0154	$0.00128
Social Science (10)	SocialScience-MS.pdf	8	8	26,113	15,169	0	71 s	$0.0106	$0.00133
Accountancy (12)	Accountancy-SQP.pdf	13	13	43,893	21,096	0	1.8 min	$0.0164	$0.00126
Accountancy (12)	Accountancy-MS.pdf	13	13	41,908	22,574	0	1.7 min	$0.0201	$0.00154
Accountancy (12)	acc3.pdf	12	71	213,806	26,249	9,217	3.2 min	$0.0397	$0.00331
Applied Mathematics (12)	Applied-Maths-SQP.pdf	9	9	30,286	13,320	0	1.5 min	$0.0097	$0.00108
Applied Mathematics (12)	Applied-Maths-MS.pdf	13	14	46,842	23,414	0	2.1 min	$0.0195	$0.00150
Biology (12)	Biology-SQP.pdf	12	12	38,892	14,885	0	1.7 min	$0.0137	$0.00114
Biology (12)	Biology-MS.pdf	8	8	26,035	14,630	0	58 s	$0.0125	$0.00157
Biotechnology (12)	Biotechnology-SQP.pdf	9	10	31,644	11,988	0	68 s	$0.0097	$0.00108
Biotechnology (12)	Biotechnology-MS.pdf	8	8	26,063	14,323	0	73 s	$0.0099	$0.00124
Chemistry (12)	Chemistry-SQP.pdf	12	12	39,534	17,662	0	1.7 min	$0.0138	$0.00115
Chemistry (12)	Chemistry-MS.pdf	12	12	38,436	18,676	0	1.9 min	$0.0145	$0.00121
Computer Science (12)	ComputerScience-SQP.pdf	8	12	33,758	15,004	0	74 s	$0.0130	$0.00162

Subject	File	Pages	AI calls	Input tokens	Output tokens	Thinking tokens	Time to read	Cost	Cost / page
Computer Science (12)	ComputerScience-MS.pdf	10	10	31,831	15,564	0	68 s	$0.0124	$0.00124
English Core (12)	EnglishCore-SQP.pdf	12	19	56,010	19,450	0	2.3 min	$0.0178	$0.00148
English Core (12)	EnglishCore-MS.pdf	9	10	31,958	14,976	0	78 s	$0.0133	$0.00148
English Elective (12)	EnglishElective-SQP.pdf	12	13	42,731	15,934	0	77 s	$0.0127	$0.00106
English Elective (12)	EnglishElective-MS.pdf	7	8	26,725	14,186	0	62 s	$0.0102	$0.00145
Entrepreneurship (12)	Entrepreneurship-SQP.pdf	10	10	32,668	13,454	0	65 s	$0.0143	$0.00143
Entrepreneurship (12)	Entrepreneurship-MS.pdf	6	6	19,476	12,623	0	48 s	$0.0132	$0.00219
Geography (12)	Geography-SQP.pdf	12	12	37,211	12,734	0	85 s	$0.0140	$0.00117
Geography (12)	Geography-MS.pdf	11	11	34,898	15,262	0	82 s	$0.0172	$0.00156
History (12)	History-SQP.pdf	10	11	33,604	12,106	0	89 s	$0.0113	$0.00113
History (12)	History-MS.pdf	10	10	33,064	16,924	0	88 s	$0.0140	$0.00140
Home Science (12)	HomeScience-SQP.pdf	4	4	12,842	7,332	0	26 s	$0.0066	$0.00165
Home Science (12)	HomeScience-MS.pdf	8	8	23,152	12,897	0	55 s	$0.0148	$0.00185
Informatics Practices (12)	InformaticsPractices-SQP.pdf	8	8	26,536	13,807	0	76 s	$0.0126	$0.00158
Informatics Practices (12)	InformaticsPractices-MS.pdf	5	5	16,585	10,785	0	56 s	$0.0077	$0.00154
Mathematics (12)	Maths-SQP.pdf	8	8	27,334	13,609	0	66 s	$0.0106	$0.00133
Mathematics (12)	Maths-MS.pdf	13	13	45,106	25,859	0	1.9 min	$0.0236	$0.00181
Physics (12)	Physics-SQP.pdf	10	10	31,687	12,272	0	71 s	$0.0102	$0.00102
Physics (12)	Physics-MS.pdf	15	15	47,906	20,870	0	1.8 min	$0.0202	$0.00135
Political Science (12)	PolSci-SQP.pdf	9	15	38,116	10,819	0	65 s	$0.0110	$0.00122
Political Science (12)	PolSci-MS.pdf	10	10	33,403	16,115	0	83 s	$0.0141	$0.00141
Sociology (12)	Sociology-SQP.pdf	8	8	25,906	10,238	0	47 s	$0.0085	$0.00106
Sociology (12)	Sociology-MS.pdf	4	4	13,963	11,227	0	27 s	$0.0098	$0.00245

Earlier run: school test set (exam/Maths, Class 8)

Step	AI calls	Input tokens	Output tokens	Cost
Question paper and answer key (2 + 2 pages)	9	19,894	6,168	$0.0054
Answer sheet read (4 pages)	21	60,014	4,437	$0.0087
Grading (8 answers)	8	15,146	4,674	$0.0036
Total (scored 18 / 30)	**38**	**95,054**	**15,279**	**$0.0177**

Notes

How it was run. Each subject was created as a teacher creates it, with its exact CBSE pattern, and its question paper and marking scheme were uploaded together. Autopilot settled every review step, as it does for a school. The run used its own test database, so no school data was touched.

Models. English-script subjects use DeepSeek; Tamil, Hindi and Sanskrit papers use Gemini 3.5 Flash, which costs more per page.

Timing. Each file is timed from the start of its first AI call to the end of its last, so time waiting in the queue is not counted.